

Notes on implementing guidelines

It is recommended that guidelines are visible, accessible, clear and consistently presented to all stakeholders and interested groups (e.g., private boaters, local residents, tourists, permit owners). Participants and organizers are aware and educated about the existing regulations and the sanctions in case of infringements.

Examples:

- [sign for private boat owners in New Zealand](#)
- *graphics produced by [Marine Wildlife Watch of the Philippines](#)*
- [Videos explaining swimming code of conduct at Three Springs Sanctuary, US](#)
- *Commercial Operator Handbook for permit holders in [Western Australia](#)*
- *Regulations and codes of conduct including an explanation of the possible consequences of noncompliance to improve their uptake (Granquist and Nilsson, 2016; Curtin et al. 2009)*

Parties are responsible for choosing the tools and strategies most likely to be effective at the specific site and jurisdiction. As mentioned in the General Guidelines, the adoption of Species- and Site-specific Guidelines to complement and enhance the general principles provided by the General Guidelines is recommended.

Parties are encouraged to collaborate with relevant international and national organizations (e.g., governmental agencies, relevant commissions and committees, research community, industry associations, NGOs) to gather insights on the variables that shape the interaction locally, including but not limited to:

- **Wildlife:** species or group of species (see Part 2 of this document), distribution, occurrence, behaviour at interaction site, sensitivity, conservation status, effects on non-targeted species and communities;
- **Environment:** sea conditions, currents, depth, habitat, water temperature, underwater visibility, other human activities;
- **Participants:** permit or licence required, water competency, expectations, attitudes, specialization, ethical and moral positioning;
- **Activity:** use of equipment and supporting devices and platforms, nature of interaction (private or commercial), timing, duration and frequency of interactions, use of attractants, general safety, community involvement, tourism market, financial sustainability, injuries and incidents during interactions;
- **Regulatory framework:** policies, governance, legislative framework, management tools, relevant authorities, conflicting interests.